

SOC workbooks and lookups

(Discover useful corporate resources to help you structure and simplify L1 alert triage)

Task 1 :- Introduction

Alert triage is complex process that often requires analysts to gather additional information about affected employees or servers. This room explores SOC workbooks designed to streamline alert triage and explains various lookup methods to quickly retrieve user and system content.

Learning objectives :-

- * Familiarise yourself with SOC investigation workbooks & learn where to find and how to use asset inventory in SOC
- * understand the importance of corporate network diagrams & practise workflow building inside an interactive storyboard

Task 2 :- Assets and Identities

Imagine having a night shift and looking into an alert saying that Gr. Baker logged into the HQ-FinFS -02 Server. Then the user downloaded the "Financial Report US 2024.xlsx" file from there and shared it with R. Lund. To correctly triage the alert and understand if activity is expected, you will have to find answers to many questions.

- * who is Gr. Baker? what are their working hours and role in company?
- * what is purpose and location of HQ-FinFS-02? who can access it?
- * why could R. Lund need access to corporate financial records?

Identity inventory :-



Identity inventory is a catalogue of corporate employees (user accounts), services (machine accounts), and their details like privileges, contacts and roles within the company. For the scenario above, Identity inventory would help you get content about Gr. Baker and R. Lund, and make it simpler to decide if the activity was expected or not.

Examples of Identity :-

Sources of Identities

Solution	Examples	Description
Active Directory	On-prem AD, Entra ID	AD itself is an identity database, and it is commonly used by SOC.
SSO providers	Okta, Google Workspace	Cloud alternatives for AD, an easy way to manage and search the users.
HR Systems	Bamboo HR, SAP, iBibb	Limited to employees only, but usually provide full employee data.
Custom Solutions	CSV or Excel sheets	It is common for IT or Security teams to maintain their own solutions.

Asset Inventory :-



Asset Inventory also called Asset lookup, is a list of all computing resources within an organization's IT environment. Note that while "asset" is a vague term and also refers to software, hardware or employees. This room emphasizes servers and workstations only. For the scenarios above, asset inventory would help you get context about the HQ-FINFS-02 server.

Example of Assets :-

Sources of Assets

Solution	Examples	Description
Active Directory	On-prem AD, Entra ID	AD is not only an identity but also a solid asset inventory database.
SIEM or EDR	Elastic, CrowdStrike	Some SIEM or EDR agents collect information about monitored hosts.
MDM Solution	MS Intune, Jamf MDM	A dedicated class of solutions created to list and manage assets.
Custom Solution	CSV or Excel sheets	Same as with identity inventory, custom solutions are common.

Quiz :-

Looking at identity inventory, what is role of R. Lund at the company?

Full Name	Username	Email	Role	Location	Access
Gregory Baker	G.Baker	g.baker@tryhatme.thm	Chief Financial Officer	Europe, UK	VPN, HQ, FINANCE
Raymond Lund	R.Lund	r.lund@tryhatme.thm	US Financial Adviser	US, Texas	VPN, FINANCE
Kate Danner	K.Danner	k.danner@tryhatme.thm	Chief Technology Officer	Europe, UK	VPN, DA, HQ, AWS
svc-veeam-06	svc-veeam-06	N/A	Backup Service Account	N/A	VEEAM, DMZ, HQ
svc-nginx-pp	svc-nginx-pp	N/A	Web App Service Account	N/A	DMZ

A) US Financial Adviser

2) Checking the Asset Inventory, what does the HQ-FINFS-02 Server store?

A)

Hostname	Location	IP Address	OS	Owner	Purpose
HQ-FINFS-02	UK Datacenter	172.16.15.89	Windows Server 2022	Central IT	File server for financial records
HQ-ADDC-01	UK Datacenter	172.16.15.10	Windows Server 2019	Central IT	Primary AD domain controller
PC-891D	London Office	192.168.5.13	Windows 11 Pro	Tech Support	Stationary PC for accountants
L007694	Remote	N/A	MacOS 13	A.Kelly, DevOps	Corporate laptop
L005325	Remote	N/A	MacOS 13	J.Eldridge, HR	Corporate laptop

Financial records

3) Finally, does the file sharing from Scenario look legitimate and expected? (Yes/No)

A) Yes